

Celebrating ACIs: **B Varun Nair, ACI Gold**

 **AUTODESK**
Certified Instructor

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Celebrating our ACIs

Autodesk has been around for more than 40 years, and the **Authorized Training Center (ATC®)** program has played its part for many of these years.

ATCs deliver high quality learning experiences to customers, industry professionals, students, and educators. They empower future innovators with deeper Autodesk product knowledge, prepare students for certification exams, and enable learners to achieve their career goals in an evolving world.

We want to recognize the role that **Autodesk Certified Instructors (ACIs)** have played – and continue to play – in the program over the last four decades. We are collecting and will share stories from ACIs, particularly from some long-standing members of the ACI community.

This story is from B Varun Nair, an ACI Gold from India. We summarize his story and share a Q&A.

If you would like to share your story, please get in touch:
learning.partners@autodesk.com



“...being an ACI makes you feel like part of the Autodesk family – a global network of professionals who are passionate about learning, innovation, and knowledge sharing. The opportunities, connections, and personal growth that come with the journey often go far beyond what you initially expect. If teaching is your passion, I would strongly encourage you to pursue it.”

B Varun Nair, ACI Gold, India

Varun's story

Varun's Autodesk journey began in 2014. Over the subsequent years, he has progressed to become an ACI Gold, building a career that has taken him across multiple countries and enabled him to work with students, professionals, academic institutions, and corporate teams around the world.

He says being an ACI is more than certification – **it validates his expertise, strengthens his professional credibility, and gives him access to a global network of Autodesk Learning Partners, instructors, and industry professionals.** Through these connections, he has been able to share knowledge internationally while continuously developing his own skills and staying aligned with the latest Autodesk technologies and industry best practices.

What motivates Varun most is seeing learners grow in confidence and apply their skills to real-world challenges. From helping students take their first steps into industry to supporting corporate teams with complex project requirements, he believes that effective training can open doors, create opportunities, and transform careers. **He enjoys tailoring learning experiences to meet the needs of different audiences, making training practical, engaging, and directly relevant to the work people do every day.**

His experience has also taught him that great instructors never stop learning. Delivering training in virtual and global environments has challenged him to constantly adapt his approach, embrace new methods of engagement, and continue learning alongside the people he instructs.

Varun describes one of the **greatest benefits of becoming an ACI as feeling part of the Autodesk family – a worldwide community united by a passion for innovation, learning, and knowledge sharing.** For him, the programme provides not only recognition and opportunity, but also a genuine sense of belonging to a global network committed to helping others succeed. It is this combination of community, continuous learning, and learner impact that continues to inspire him.



IEEE MMU Student Branch, Multimedia University - MMU Cyberjaya, Malaysia.

Why did you decide to become an ACI?

“My journey began in 2014 when I joined an Autodesk Authorized Training Center as a trainer. Over the years, I had the opportunity to work with Autodesk technologies extensively and gradually progressed to become an Autodesk Certified Instructor.

“During this journey, I was fortunate to travel to multiple countries and deliver training programs for students, working professionals, corporate teams, and academic institutions. These experiences allowed me to interact with learners from diverse backgrounds and understand the global impact that quality technical education can create.

“Becoming an ACI was a natural step in my professional growth. It gave me the platform to validate my expertise while aligning with Autodesk’s global standards for instruction.

“More importantly, it strengthened my belief that sharing knowledge can create opportunities and transform careers. I realized that through teaching, I could contribute to the success of individuals and organizations around the world. For me, educating others while continuously learning ourselves is one of the most valuable contributions we can make to our professional community.”



Linton University College, Malaysia



“For learners and customers, working with an ACI provides confidence that they are receiving training aligned with Autodesk standards.”

B Varun Nair, ACI Gold, India

How has being an ACI helped you and your learners?



Autodesk Learning Partners Summit, India.

“Being an Autodesk Certified Instructor has significantly enhanced my professional credibility and helped me stand apart from many regular software trainers in the market. Through Autodesk and the Autodesk Learning Partner network, I have had continuous opportunities to stay updated with the latest software releases, technologies, and industry best practices, allowing me to deliver relevant and high-quality training.

“Over the years, I have trained students, professionals, academic institutions, and corporate teams across multiple countries, both in classroom settings and virtual environments. My journey alongside Autodesk—from Standard to Silver and now Gold-level partnerships—has given me the confidence and recognition to deliver training programs for organizations around the world.

“For learners and customers, working with an ACI provides confidence that they are receiving training aligned with Autodesk standards. I always strive to provide accurate, practical, and well-researched guidance, often supported by official Autodesk resources, helping learners develop skills they can apply successfully in their careers and projects.”

What motivates you to continue teaching Autodesk skills?

“Teaching Autodesk skills has been one of the most rewarding parts of my career. Becoming an Autodesk Certified Instructor gave me global recognition and opened opportunities to collaborate with Autodesk Learning Partners and training organizations across the world, including NetCom Learning, CAD Training Online, Global eTraining, Jewish Welfare Service, SourceCAD, EduCADD, and many others. Through these collaborations, I have had the privilege of working with learners and professionals from different countries and industries.

“What motivates me most is seeing learners gain confidence and successfully apply their skills in real projects. Many of my training engagements are with corporate teams that have specific business challenges and learning objectives. I enjoy customizing training programs to meet their requirements and connecting software features with practical project workflows.

“By combining real-world examples with Autodesk-approved learning resources such as ASCENT courseware, I strive to make every training session meaningful, engaging, and directly applicable to the learner’s work environment.

“Every successful learner, completed project, and positive feedback reinforces my passion for teaching and motivates me to continue sharing Autodesk knowledge with professionals around the globe.”



International students in Malaysia.

What has been your biggest learning as an ACI?



Autodesk partners meet

“One of my biggest learnings has been adapting myself to deliver effective training programs for global partners and corporate clients in a virtual environment. Teaching design and engineering software online is not always easy, as it requires keeping learners engaged while ensuring they fully understand complex workflows and tools. This challenge encouraged me to continuously improve my training methods and explore new ways of making online learning interactive, practical, and effective.

“Being an ACI opened opportunities to collaborate with multiple Autodesk Learning Partners across the world. Through these experiences, I learned different approaches to online instruction, learner engagement, and knowledge sharing, which helped me become a more versatile trainer.

“Another valuable aspect has been access to Autodesk's enablement resources and training programs, which allow instructors to stay updated with the latest software releases, features, and industry trends. This continuous learning process has helped me maintain up-to-date skills and deliver relevant, high-quality training to learners and organizations worldwide.

“Overall, my biggest learning has been that great instructors never stop learning themselves. The more we evolve with technology and learning methods, the more value we can create for our learners.”

What would you say to someone who wants to become an ACI?

“If you are passionate about teaching Autodesk design software and helping others grow, becoming an Autodesk Certified Instructor is one of the best decisions you can make. It is much more than a certification—it is a platform that gives you the confidence, recognition, and opportunities to grow as a professional trainer.

“For anyone who wants to build a career as an instructor, the ACI program provides a strong foundation to develop both technical expertise and teaching skills. It helps you stand out globally, enhances your professional credibility, and connects you with the wider Autodesk community. In my own journey, becoming an ACI opened doors to collaborate with Autodesk Learning Partners and organizations across different countries, allowing me to expand my knowledge, share experiences, and continuously improve my skills.

“Most importantly, being an ACI makes you feel like part of the Autodesk family—a global network of professionals who are passionate about learning, innovation, and knowledge sharing. The opportunities, connections, and personal growth that come with the journey often go far beyond what you initially expect. If teaching is your passion, I would strongly encourage you to pursue it.”



Autodesk Learning Partner Summit 2018

